

Jair L. Siqueira Neto, PhD., MBA

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

A seasoned scientific leader with 19 years of experience driving innovative research from basic biology to clinical candidates, with academic pharmaceutical industry experience. Expertise in leveraging functional genomics, in vivo pharmacology, and high-throughput technologies to deconvolute disease mechanisms and advance therapeutics. A proven leader skilled in building and mentoring high-performing teams, managing complex cross-functional and industry-academia collaborations, and applying strategic project management to accelerate drug discovery. Eager to apply this unique blend of scientific depth and business acumen to manage, accelerate, and innovate the drug discovery and development process.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Leadership & People Management:** Strategic Planning | Team Leadership & Mentoring | Performance Management & Career Development | Constructive Feedback | Stakeholder Communication
- **Drug Discovery & Development:** Target Identification & Validation | HTS Assay Development | Lead Optimization | Preclinical Package Management | Translational Research
- **In Vivo Expertise:** Animal Model Development | IACUC Protocol Design & Review | Hands-on Animal Handling (Dosing, Blood Collection, Necropsy) | *In Vivo* Imaging (IVIS) | General Breeding & Colony Management
- **Functional Genomics & 'Omics:** Resistance selection | Transcriptomics | Spatial Metabolomics | Next-Generation Sequencing (NGS)
- **Project & Consortium Management:** Agile & Waterfall Methodologies | Budget & Resource Allocation | Risk Assessment & Go/No-Go Decision Making | Cross-Functional Collaboration

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Novartis | La Jolla, CA

Principal Scientist | Jan 2026

- **Research Collaboration Lead:** Responsible for interacting with Disease Area leadership to support in vivo studies, coordinating with Comparative Medicine scientists. Manages a team of 6 scientists.
- **Digital In Vivo Technology:** Responsible for the development of innovative solutions based on digital biomarkers for in vivo pharmacology studies, advancing candidates to pre-clinical and clinical stages.

University of California, San Diego (UCSD) | La Jolla, CA

Principal Investigator & Director, UCSD Screening Core | Jul 2014 – Jan 2026

- **Leadership & Team Development:** Led a multidisciplinary team of scientists, postdocs, and students. Actively mentored and supported career development, providing training, constructive feedback, and delegation to foster independence; multiple trainees have advanced to leadership roles in academia and industry.
- **Project & Portfolio Management:** Orchestrated multiple simultaneous research projects and collaborations, defining objectives, timelines, and key deliverables. Applied project management principles to drive projects toward critical decision points.

- **Strategic Collaboration & Influence:** Served as the **Malaria Drug Accelerator (MaIDA) Consortium Manager**, a Gates Foundation-funded partnership with Novartis, GSK, MMV, and leading academic institutions. Directed project oversight, strategic planning, and presented progress updates, providing data-driven Go/No-Go recommendations to key stakeholders.
- **In Vivo Research & Animal Science:**
 - Conducted hands-on *in vivo* research including animal handling, infection models (IP, IV, oral gavage), blood collection, necropsy, histology, and *in vivo* imaging (IVIS).
 - As a **6-year member of the IACUC**, reviewed over 200 animal research protocols, gaining a comprehensive understanding of humane endpoints, experimental design, and regulatory compliance across diverse disease areas.
- **Innovative Research & Technical Advancement:** Pioneered the development of novel, revolutionary cell-based HTS assays for parasitic diseases (leishmaniasis, Chagas disease, SARS-CoV2), directly enabling drug discovery campaigns. Applied cutting-edge functional genomics (resistance selection, spatial 'omics) to identify novel targets and mechanisms of action.

University of California, San Francisco (UCSF) | San Francisco, CA

Specialist, Department of Pathology | Jan 2013 – Jun 2014

- Developed and executed *in vitro* and *in vivo* efficacy models to support early-stage drug discovery programs, strengthening the translational link between basic research and therapeutic impact.

Institut Pasteur Korea | South Korea

Team Leader | Jul 2009 – Dec 2012

- Coordinated international high-throughput screening (HTS) campaigns, managing the screening of >500,000 compounds. Collaborated directly with pharmaceutical partners (e.g., DNDi), operating in a goal-oriented, milestone-driven environment.

EDUCATION

Master of Business Administration (MBA) | University of São Paulo, Brazil (2023-2025)
Ranked #1 university in Latin America

Postdoctoral Fellowship, Drug Discovery | Institut Pasteur Korea (2007-2009)

Ph.D., Genetics, Microbiology, and Molecular Biology | UNICAMP** (2007)

B.S., Biological Sciences & Molecular Biology | UNICAMP** (2003)

SELECTED ACCOMPLISHMENTS & PUBLICATIONS

- **Secured over \$16M** in competitive funding from NIH, philanthropy, and industry partners to support drug discovery initiatives.
- **Advanced K777/SLV213 compound to Phase I/II clinical trials**, managing the *in vitro* efficacy experiments submitted in the preclinical data package that supported regulatory approval for human testing.
- **Inventor on US Patent 12,251,372 B2** for antileishmanial compounds and compositions.
- **Siqueira-Neto, J.L. et al. (2023)** Antimalarial drug discovery: progress and approaches. *Nat Rev Drug Discovery*
- **Author of 80+ peer-reviewed publications** in high-impact journals including *Science*, *Cancer Discovery*, *Cell Stem Cell*, and *Nature Reviews Drug Discovery* (>4,259 citations).